Problem-Solution Fit Canvas: Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)

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Define CS, fit into CC

1. CUSTOMER SEGMENT(S) — CS

- ServiceNow administrators and developers who load bulk data into the platform.
- HR and data-operations teams who send employee data as Excel spreadsheets.
- IT managers who need accurate, up-to-date employee records for assignments, approvals and reporting.
- Secondary: employees and service desk agents who rely on correct employee details in ServiceNow.

6. CUSTOMER CONSTRAINTS — CC

- Data arrives in spreadsheet format (Excel/CSV), so it cannot be used directly in the target table.
- Records must be loaded in bulk without manual entry, and without creating duplicates.
- Employee ID must stay the unique identifier, so existing records are updated and new ones inserted.
- Imports must be tested on a dev instance and be repeatable and fit change control (update sets).
- Users are often beginners with limited knowledge of Import Sets and Transform Maps.

5. AVAILABLE SOLUTIONS — AS

- Manual entry of each employee record: slow, error-prone and not scalable.
- Direct table edits or list-view copy and paste: risky, with no validation or mapping.
- Custom scripts or integrations: powerful but complex and costly for a simple file import.
- Importing without a unique key (coalesce): creates duplicate employee records.
- Ad-hoc fixes after import: cause rework and weaken data integrity.

Explore AS, differentiate

Focus on J&P, tap into BE, understand RC

2. JOBS-TO-BE-DONE / PROBLEMS — J&P

- Load employee data (Employee ID, Name, Email, Department, Location) from a spreadsheet into ServiceNow.
- Stage the data temporarily in an Import Set table before it reaches the live table.
- Map source columns to the matching fields in the target Employee table.
- Update existing employees and insert new ones, using Employee ID as the coalesce field.
- Verify the imported records for accuracy and completeness.

9. PROBLEM ROOT CAUSE — RC

- Spreadsheet column names and structure do not match the ServiceNow table fields.
- Without a staging area and mapping, data is loaded without validation or control.
- No unique identifier is applied during import, so records are duplicated or overwritten incorrectly.
- Beginners are unsure how Import Sets, Transform Maps and coalescing work together.
- Result: inconsistent employee data, rework and unreliable reporting.

7. BEHAVIOUR — BE

- The admin receives an Excel file with employee details from HR.
- The admin uploads the file via Data Source and loads it into an Import Set table.
- The admin creates a Transform Map, maps fields and sets Employee ID as the coalesce field.
- The admin runs the transform and checks the Transform History and target table for errors.
- The admin corrects any mapping problems and re-runs, then moves the configuration to production via update set.

Focus on J&P, tap into BE, understand RC

Identify strong TR & EM

3. TRIGGERS — TR

- Onboarding of a new batch of employees, or a company-wide employee data update.
- Receipt of a new spreadsheet from HR containing new or changed employee details.
- Reports showing missing, outdated or duplicate employee records.
- Complaints from managers about incorrect employee information.

4. EMOTIONS: BEFORE / AFTER — EM

- **Before:** overwhelmed by manual entry, worried about duplicates and errors, and unsure how the import works.
- **After:** confident and in control, because the process is structured and results can be verified.
- **Admins and managers:** from worrying about data quality to trusting reliable employee records.

10. YOUR SOLUTION — SL

- Upload the spreadsheet into an Import Set table, which acts as a staging area for validation.
- Configure a Transform Map that maps Employee ID, Name, Email, Department and Location to the target Employee table fields.
- Use Employee ID as the coalesce field, so existing employees are updated and new employees are inserted.
- Execute the transform and verify the created and updated records in the target table and the transform history.
- **Fit with the customer:** it handles bulk data, avoids duplicates and suits beginners through a clear, repeatable process.
- **Outcome:** fast, accurate and consistent employee data migration with preserved data integrity.

8.1 ONLINE (8. CHANNELS of BEHAVIOUR) — CH

- ServiceNow web UI: Data Sources, Import Sets and Transform Maps modules.
- Reviewing Import Set rows, Transform History and the target table after execution.
- Searching ServiceNow documentation and community for import and coalesce guidance.
- Dev instance (e.g. Personal Developer Instance) for building and testing the import.
- Email or shared drives for receiving spreadsheets from HR.

8.2 OFFLINE (8. CHANNELS of BEHAVIOUR) — CH

- Meetings with HR to agree on the spreadsheet format and required fields.
- Team discussions and training sessions on the import process.
- Review sessions where managers confirm that employee data is correct.
- Interviews with admins and HR about common data-import problems.

Extract online & offline CH of BE

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